



‘Heights’ of greatness: The top 20 men averaged 5’9” in 1973, shot up to 6’ in 1989, and now stands at 6’2.85”. Close to that average are the legendary Big Three of 6’2” Novak Djokovic, 6’1” Rafael Nadal, and 6’1” Roger Federer.

For men, they are as follows: The Shorter but Highly Successful Range (6’), The Ideal Balance Range (6’ to 6’5”), and The Taller Players (6’6” +). The women’s ranges are The Shorter but Highly Successful Range (5’ 6”), The Ideal Balance Range (5’7” to 5’11”), and The Taller Players (6’+).

In general, shorter players tend to rely more on speed and agility and can handle low balls better. Medium-height players offer a balanced mix of power, speed, and endurance.

Taller players benefit from greater reach and power, especially on serves, but may face challenges with movement and agility.

During parts of their careers, leading American players Mardy Fish, Lindsay Davenport, Taylor Townsend, Jack Sock, and Andy Roddick, as well as Europeans Marion Bartoli, Anastasia Pavlyuchenkova, and Jelena Ostapenko, have been significantly overweight. **How does a tennis player determine their ideal weight range?**

Here are the six ways to determine the ideal weight range:

❶ Assess Body Composition (Not Just Scale Weight)

◆ Lean Mass vs. Fat Mass: Tennis players should aim for a lean physique with a high muscle-to-fat ratio while avoiding excessive bulk.

◆ Body Fat Percentage:

◆ Men: ~8-12%

◆ Women: ~16-22%

◆ DEXA Scan, BodPod, or Skinfold Measurements can help assess body composition.

❷ Consider Playing Style and Positioning

◆ Baseliners (Endurance and Speed): Need a lighter weight to move efficiently and sustain long rallies.

◆ Serve-and-Volley (Explosive Power and Strength): May carry a bit more muscle mass for explosive bursts.

❸ Strength-to-Weight Ratio

◆ More strength without excess weight improves acceleration and agility.

◆ A strength test, such as relative squat/deadlift ratios, ensures enough power without slowing movement.

❹ Energy Expenditure and Metabolic Needs

◆ Players burn 800–1,500+ kcal/hour in matches.

◆ They must maintain a sustainable weight that allows adequate caloric intake for performance and recovery.

❺ Injury History and Joint Health

◆ Carrying extra weight — even lean muscle — increases impact forces on knees, ankles, and the